

Hyper-Local Rent vs. Buy

Opportunity Cost Calculator

A rent-vs-buy calculator that doesn't ignore what your down payment could have earned you elsewhere.

Live now: onevvish.github.io/rentVsbuy

The Problem

Every rent-vs-buy calculator online asks the same lopsided question:

| "Is your monthly mortgage payment more or less than rent?"

That's the wrong comparison. It ignores the single biggest number in the decision:

What if you invested your down payment instead of locking it into a house?

A \$130K down payment invested in the market for 30 years can be worth **over a million dollars** on its own — most calculators pretend that opportunity doesn't exist.

The Solution

A calculator that runs the comparison honestly:

- **Buyer** — builds home equity, pays the mortgage, taxes, insurance, maintenance
- **Renter** — invests the down payment *and* whatever they save each month vs. the buyer's costs

Every dollar of "if you didn't buy, where would that money go?" is tracked, for 30 years, side by side.

Hyper-Local to California

Type a zip code, get real defaults for that market instantly:

- Home price & comparable rent
- Local property tax rate
- 35+ major CA metros mapped exactly; every other CA zip falls back to a regional estimate

Hyper-Local Rent vs. Buy Opportunity Cost Calculator

Most calculators ignore the opportunity cost of your down payment. This one invests it in the stock market and tracks a true 30-year net worth comparison.

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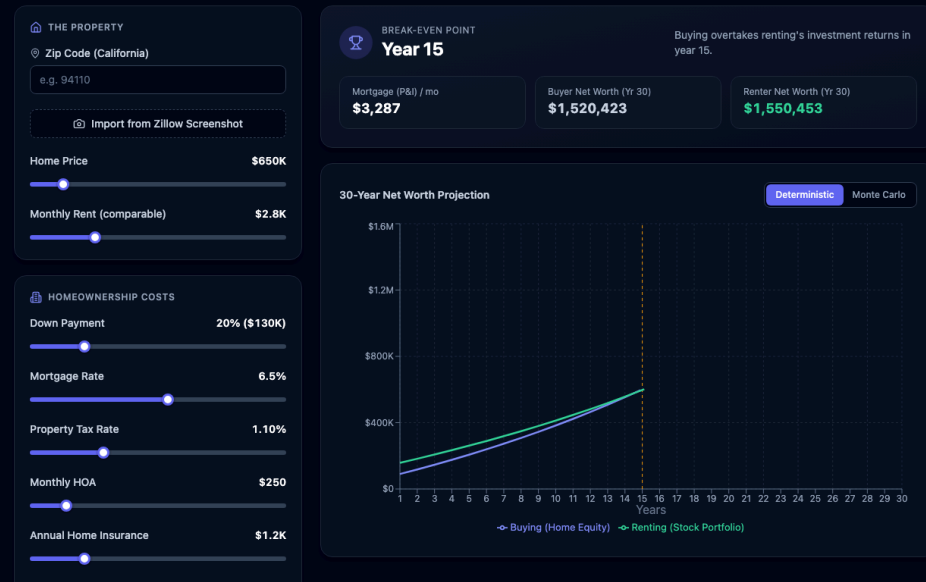
One Clear Answer: When Does Buying Win?

- **Break-even year** — the year buying's net worth overtakes renting's
- Full 30-year net worth chart for both paths
- Real costs modeled: mortgage, property tax, insurance, maintenance, selling costs

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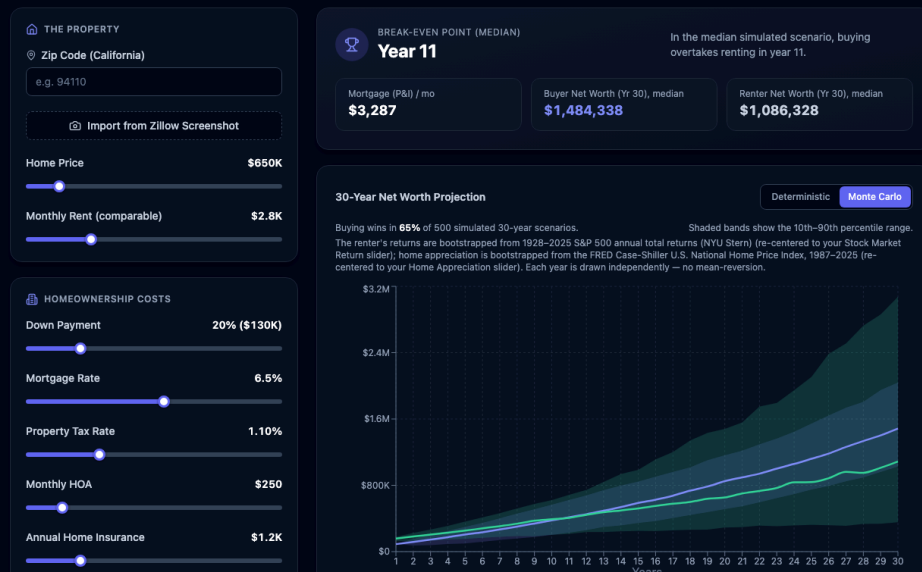
Beyond a Single Guess: Monte Carlo Risk

Markets don't move in a straight line. Toggle to see a **range of outcomes**, not just one:

- Stock returns bootstrapped from real **1928–2025 S&P 500** history
- Home appreciation bootstrapped from the real **FRED Case-Shiller index**
- 500 simulated 30-year scenarios → "buying wins in 67% of outcomes"

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Full Tax Picture, Not Just the Basics

Most calculators stop at property tax. This one models what actually shows up on a tax return:

Feature	What it captures
Prop 13 cap	CA property tax assessment capped at 2%/year growth
Itemized deductions	Mortgage interest + property tax vs. standard deduction
Section 121 exclusion	Home-sale gains tax-free up to \$250K / \$500K
Capital gains tax	On the renter's investment gains, federal + state

Share Any Scenario Instantly

One click encodes every input — home price, rates, tax settings, chart tab — into a link.

Send someone your exact numbers. No accounts, no saving, no re-entering data.

Try It Right Now

onevvish.github.io/rentVsbuy

Free. No sign-up. Live on GitHub Pages, auto-deployed on every update.

What's Next

- Expand hyper-local defaults beyond California
- Model PMI for buyers under 20% down
- CA rent-control caps (AB 1482) on the Rent Inflation assumption
- Upfront closing costs as part of the renter's invested capital

Questions?

onevvish.github.io/rentVsbuy
github.com/OneVVish/rentVsbuy